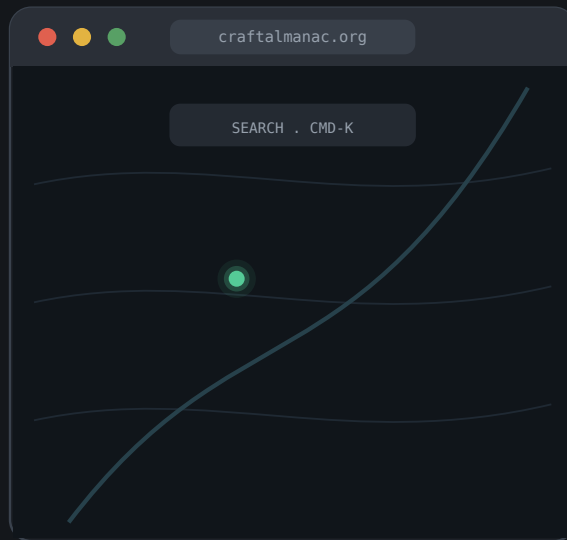


Round 3 -- Three versions of the site

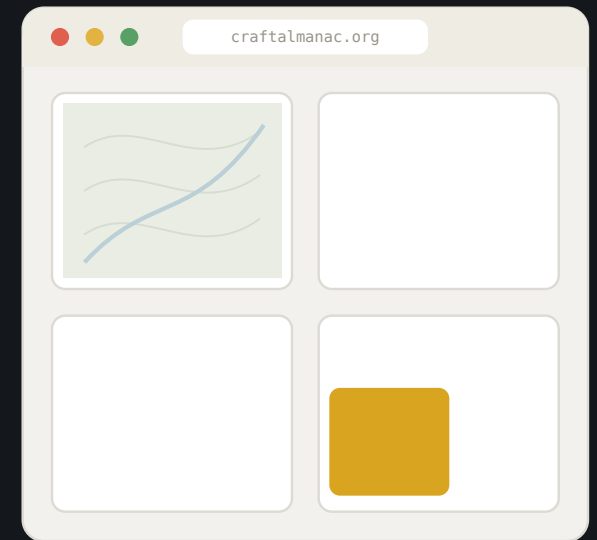
A broad pass through contemporary web design -- the sites the field celebrates, regardless of subject -- applied to what this site must do: an interactive map, plant cards, and project recipes. Identity deliberately decoupled from Round 2; these are UX worlds.



A . FIELD DESK



B . THE LONG SEASON



C . CARD TABLE

June 2026 . follows round-2-directions.pdf . wireframe fidelity, flavor only hinted

What the site must do, before any style

The map

Lazy-loading occurrence data, three modes, access-status overlays, popups with rules. Must feel alive at first touch and stay fast at zoom 8+.

Plant cards

One page per material: ID traits, season histogram, safety tags, harvest ethics, rules. Must cite cleanly in class and read well on a phone in the field.

Project recipes

Step-by-step craft guides that bring materials together -- gather, prepare, make. Need a hands-busy mode: big steps, progress, no hunting.

Teaching + ethics constants

Projector-friendly, printable, occurrence-is-not-permission placed prominently, safety colors semantic and fixed in every version.

THIS ROUND'S RULES

- Research the genre, not the mission: sites famous for design, any subject.
- Three versions = three UX paradigms, not three palettes.
- Identity from Rounds 1-2 deliberately set aside; any world can re-skin these bones.
- Everything proposed must be buildable static: vanilla JS, CSS, Mapbox GL.

Method: three research families below (the award tier, the product-UX school, the editorial school), distilled to patterns, then three versions that commit to one paradigm each -- the same forced-apart discipline as Round 2, applied to UX.

The award tier

What the field celebrates when nothing is at stake but wonder.

Lando Norris -- OFF+BRAND AWWWARDS SITE OF THE YEAR 2025

Every pixel moves at race pace, yet it loads fast: lazy assets, lean code, motion budgeted to the subject. Spectacle that is the content, not on it.

Take: motion earns its place only when it expresses the data underneath.

Messenger AWWWARDS SOTY 2025 -- A WEBGL PLANET IN THE BROWSER

Console-game physics and lighting in a web page. Proof of appetite for worlds, not pages -- visitors will explore if you give them terrain.

Take: our terrain already exists; the map can carry world-feel without WebGL.

Bruno Simon portfolio SITE OF THE MONTH, JAN 2026 -- DRIVABLE 3D WORLD

Navigation as play. People remember the toy car years later. Joy is a retention strategy the field keeps underrating.

Take: one playable element (a season scrubber, a tilt card) beats ten animations.

The product-UX school

Calm, keyboard-fast, map-literate -- the tools people live in.

Linear / Vercel THE PRODUCT-UX GOLD STANDARD

Dark calm surfaces, glowing borders, bento feature grids, obsessive micro-interaction quality. Influenced thousands of products because it reads as competence.

Take: calm + precise = trust. Good frame for safety-critical content.

Felt 2.0 COLLABORATIVE MAPS AS PRODUCT

Toolbar slimmed so the map gets the room; tools appear when relevant. A map app that feels like a design tool, not GIS.

Take: chrome recedes, map breathes -- our current sidebar does the opposite.

Raycast / cmd-K culture LINEAR, GITHUB, NOTION, VERCEL

The command palette became the universal power-user door: one keystroke, fuzzy search, every noun and verb of the app.

Take: 'find chanterelle / jump to park / open ink recipe' is one ~100-line palette away.

Airbnb maps THE CONSUMER MAP BENCHMARK

Cards and map in conversation: hover a card, the pin lifts; pan the map, cards refilter. The list IS the map.

Take: bind plant cards to viewport -- the almanac rewrites itself as you pan.

The editorial school + 2026 currents

Scroll as narrative, and the field's turn toward calm.

NYT Snow Fall + The Pudding THE SCROLLYTELLING CANON

Pulitzer-grade narrative where scroll position drives scenes. The Pudding turned 145 years of records into a scroll you feel. Step-based libraries (Scrollama) made the pattern cheap.

Take: a season is already a narrative; 'what is happening this week' wants this form.

Stripe / Apple product pages COMMERCIAL SCROLLYTELLING

Sticky panes, scroll-driven reveals, type that responds. The technique sells phones; it can teach foraging.

Take: recipes as stepped scenes with a progress thread, print button at the end.

2026 currents CALM UI, FUNCTIONAL MICRO-INTERACTIONS

The field is correcting: away from visual theatrics toward calm interfaces; micro-interactions that reassure (45% engagement lift when functional, not decorative); scroll-driven CSS animations now native; variable fonts as living type; View Transitions for free page morphs.

Take: every flourish we ship must do work -- and most now cost zero JS.

Six patterns worth owning -- all static-buildable

CMD-K PALETTE

one keystroke to any plant, park, or recipe; ~100 lines of vanilla JS

MAP-CARD BINDING

Airbnb's conversation: pan the map, the cards refilter; hover a card, the pin lifts

SCROLL SCENES

native CSS scroll-driven animation; the season tells itself; reduced-motion safe

STICKY SPREADS

editorial plant pages: specimen pane holds while text scrolls past it

BENTO SURFACES

Apple/Linear grids let six things be glanceable without a long scroll

CARD OBJECTS + VIEW TRANSITIONS

tiles morph into pages for free; cards tilt, flip, and carry status

Each version below leads with two of these and declines the rest. The discipline from Round 2 holds: if two versions could share a screenshot, one is wrong.

Field Desk

The map is the app. Everything else floats.

Craft Almanac as an instrument you open, not a site you visit. The map fills the viewport from the first frame; search, cards, recipes, and the season itself are layers floating above it. Built on the Linear/Felt school: calm dark chrome, keyboard-first, every micro-interaction doing reassurance work. The current app's bones (panel + map) evolved into a true tool.

LEADS WITH

Cmd-K palette; map-card binding. Glass layers, season scrubber, URL state.

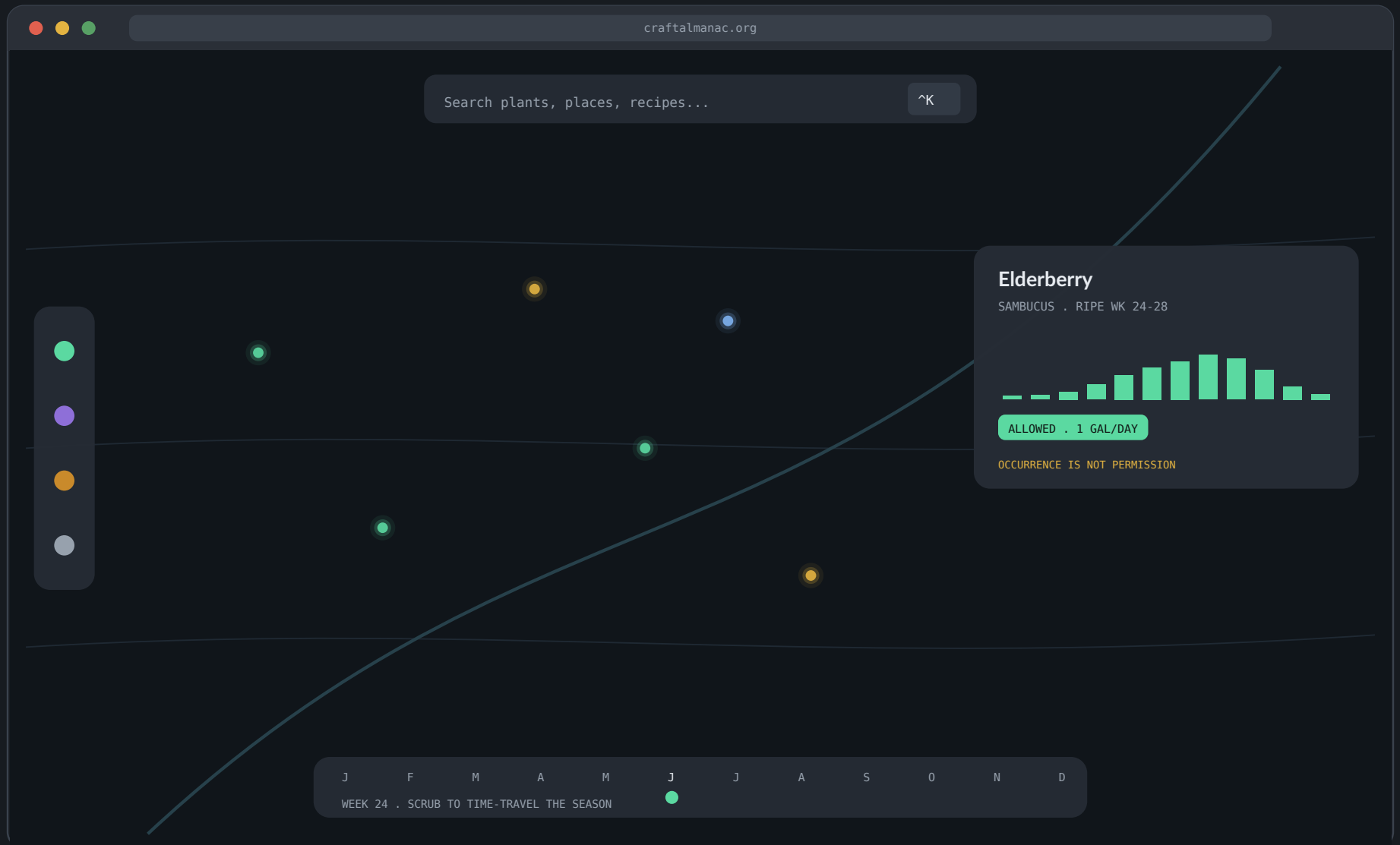
DECLINES

Scroll scenes; bento. The instrument never scrolls.

PRECEDENTS

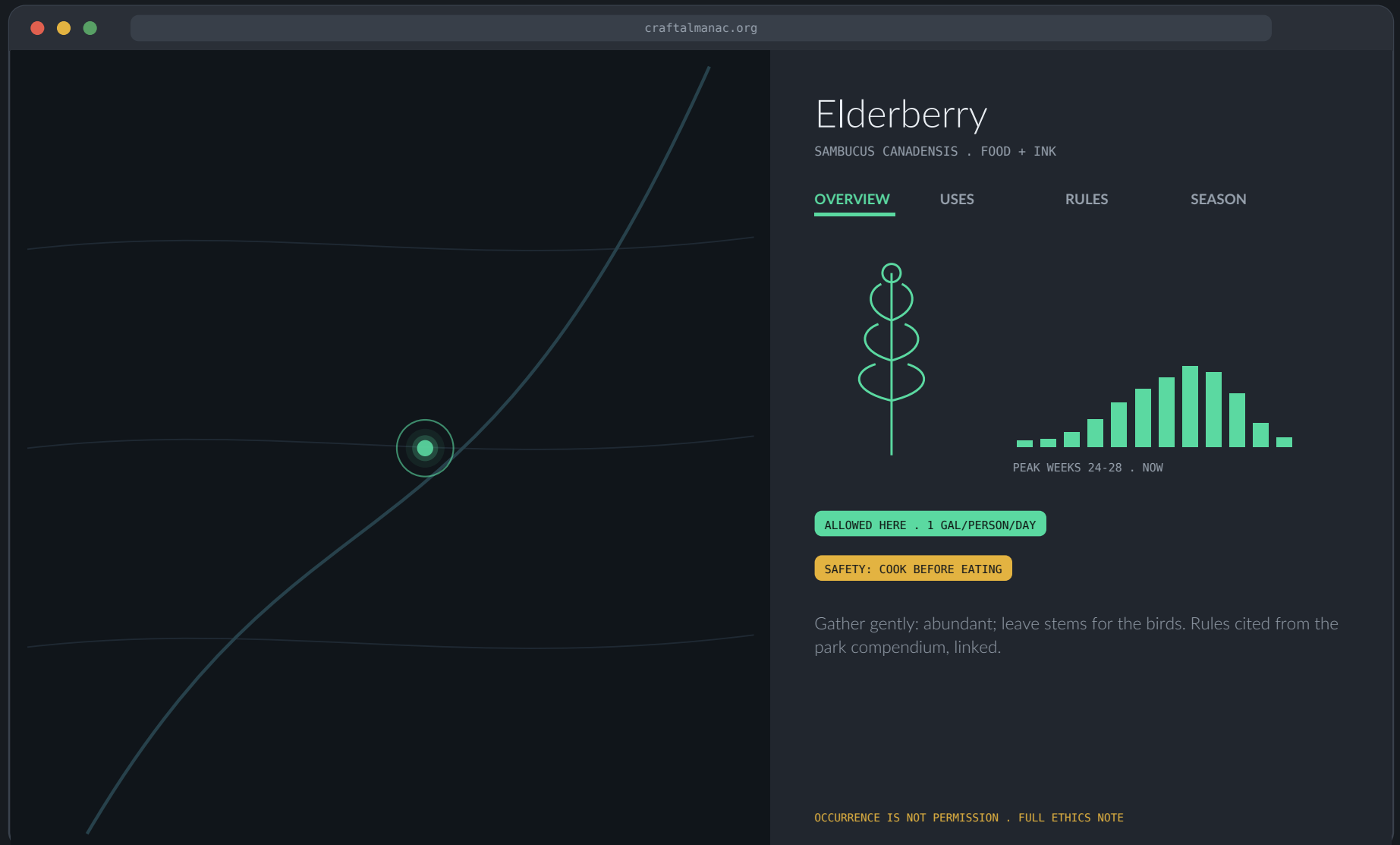
Linear, Felt 2.0, Raycast, Airbnb maps, Vercel.

VERSION A / THE MAP IS THE HOME PAGE



No landing page: the URL opens the instrument, state lives in the URL, and the palette is the navigation. Hover a glow, get the peek card; pan, and the (collapsed) card list refilters Airbnb-style. The scrubber replays the year.

VERSION A / PLANT CARD = SIDE SHEET OVER THE MAP



The point stays lit on the map while its sheet is open -- place and plant in one view. Esc closes; a View Transition morphs sheet to full page for print/cite. On mobile the sheet becomes a bottom drawer, the app-standard gesture.

craftalmanac.org

OAK GALL INK

6 STEPS . 2 DAYS . EASY

1. Gather galls

2. Crush + soak

3. Add iron water

4. Strain

5. Bind

6. Write

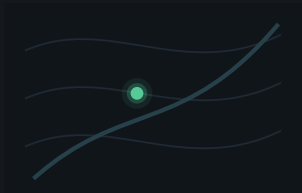
STEP 3 OF 6

Add iron water; watch it turn.

Pour the iron liquor in slowly. The tannin bath shifts from tea-brown to blue-black in seconds -- this is the reaction that wrote Europe's archives for a thousand years.

TIMER . SOAK 72 H REMAINING 14 H

SAFETY: IRON STAINS . GLOVES



WHERE TO GATHER

MATERIALS: GALLS 20 . RAINWATER 500ML . IRON LIQUOR . GUM ARABIC -- TAP ANY TO SEE IT ON THE MAP

Hands-busy UX: arrow keys or space advance steps; the rail shows progress; timers persist in the tab title. Materials link back to the map -- the recipe and the territory stay one object.

VERSION A / MOTION, TECH + RISK

INTERACTION	BEHAVIOR	COST
Palette opens	scale 0.98-1, fade, 140ms -- Raycast timing	vanilla JS, ~100 lines
Peek card	slides 8px up, spring-out; pin glow pulses once	CSS transition + keyframe
Season scrub	data crossfades per month bucket; URL updates	existing chunk loader
Sheet to page	card morphs to full plant page	View Transitions API, free
Glass panels	smoked translucency over the map	backdrop-filter, 1 line
Keyboard map	/, k, esc, arrows -- full keyboard path	keydown router

RISKS

Reads as a power tool: first-time visitors may not discover the palette or scrubber. Mitigation: an opening hint sequence (three quiet tooltips, once), and the peek cards carry the warmth -- voice and illustration live there. Dark-only chrome inherits Round 2's daylight-classroom concern; same daybreak answer applies.

The Long Season

You arrive mid-story. The scroll carries you.

Craft Almanac as a publication that happens to contain an instrument. You arrive mid-story -- the week's entry, written from live data -- and scroll through what the season is doing near you; the map enters pinned, like a character. Plant pages are sticky editorial spreads; recipes are stepped stories. The scrollytelling canon (Snow Fall, The Pudding, Stripe) spent on a living calendar instead of a one-off feature.

LEADS WITH

Scroll scenes; sticky spreads. Variable type, progress threads, print endings.

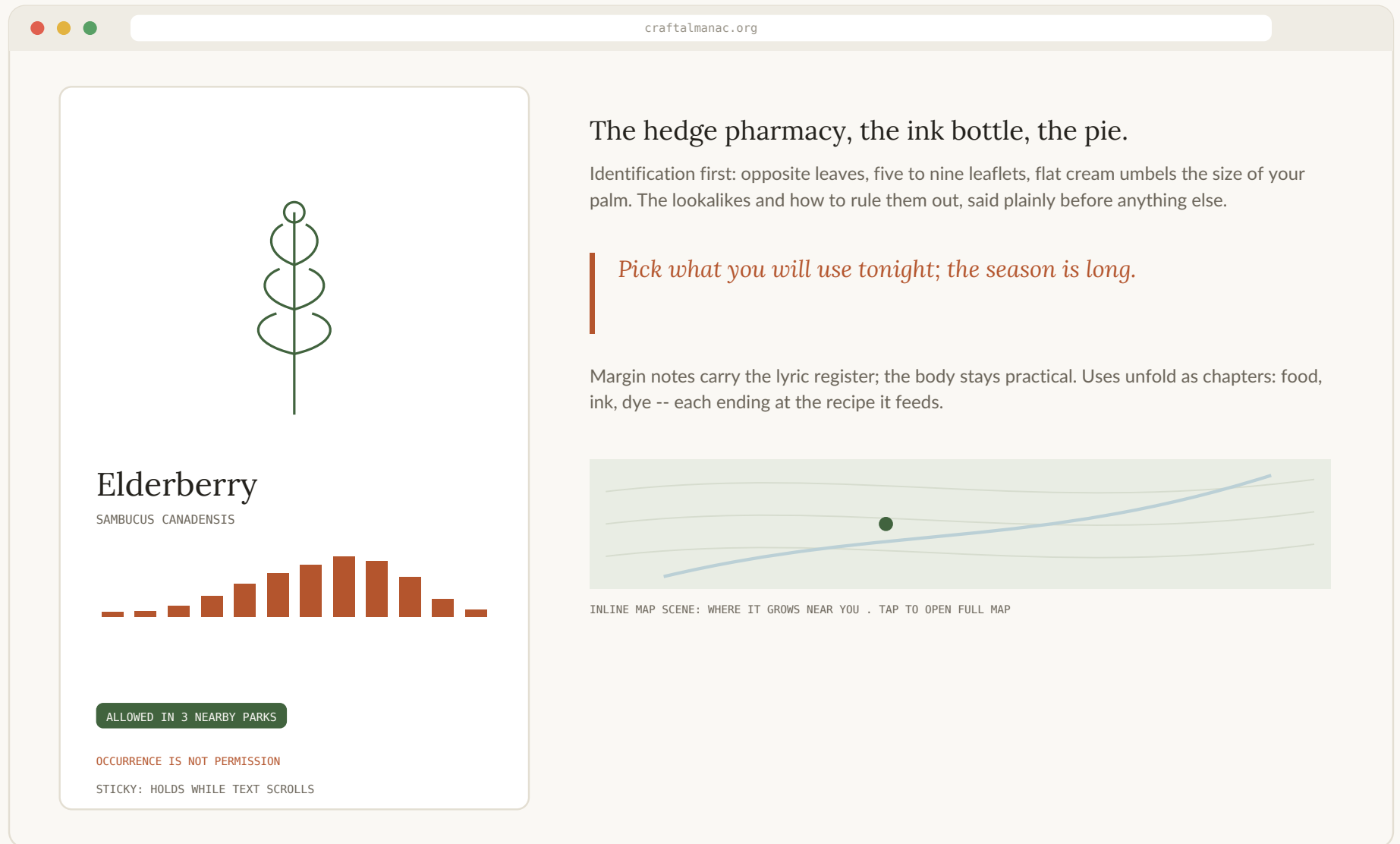
DECLINES

Cmd-K as primary nav; bento. One thread at a time.

PRECEDENTS

NYT Snow Fall, The Pudding, Stripe, Apple product pages.

CRAFT ALMANAC / SITE VERSIONS / ROUND 3



The Stripe/Apple sticky-spread, spent on a plant: specimen pane holds (with histogram and live rule status) while the article scrolls past. Reads beautifully on phones as a simple stack; prints as a clean one-pager for class.

craftalmanac.org

Ink from oak galls

Six steps, two days, a thousand years of archives.

III OF VI

Add iron water; watch it turn.

The bath shifts from tea-brown to blue-black in seconds. This is the chemistry monks trusted with scripture; your jar is part of that line. Iron stains -- gloves on, said plainly.

STEP I OPENS AS A MAP SCENE: WHERE THE GALLS ARE

PRINT THE BROADSIDE

STICKY MATERIALS: GALLS . RAINWATER . IRON . GUM -- EACH LINKS TO ITS CARD

Each step is a scroll scene with one job; the thread shows where you are. Hands-busy mode is just bigger type and space-to-advance -- same page, same scroll. Ends with the printable one-sheet, because finished things leave the screen.

VERSION B / MOTION, TECH + RISK

INTERACTION	BEHAVIOR	COST
Scroll scenes	map pans/zooms keyed to scroll position	CSS scroll-timeline + Mapbox flyTo
Sticky spreads	specimen pane holds, text scrolls	position: sticky, zero JS
Headline life	display weight breathes on scroll	variable font axis, CSS only
Scene steps	IntersectionObserver advances scenes	Scrollama pattern, ~60 lines
Reduced motion	every scene readable as static stack	prefers-reduced-motion
Return visits	remembers you; opens map pill prominent	localStorage flag

RISKS

Narrative front door can slow task-driven users ('is the elderberry ripe?'). Mitigations: the pill is always visible, search is in the header, and the story honors deep links -- every scene is a URL. Editorial demands fresh writing; the weekly entry must assemble itself from data (week, mode, region) with an owner override, or it will rot.

Card Table

Everything is a card you can pick up.

Craft Almanac as a table of beautiful objects. Home is a bento of live tiles; every plant is a literal card that tilts and flips; every recipe is a deck of step cards you work through with one hand. The most touchable and most classroom-portable version -- cards print and cut out. Joy is the strategy, with hard guardrails where play meets safety.

LEADS WITH

Bento surfaces; card objects + View Transitions. Tilt, flip, swipe, morph.

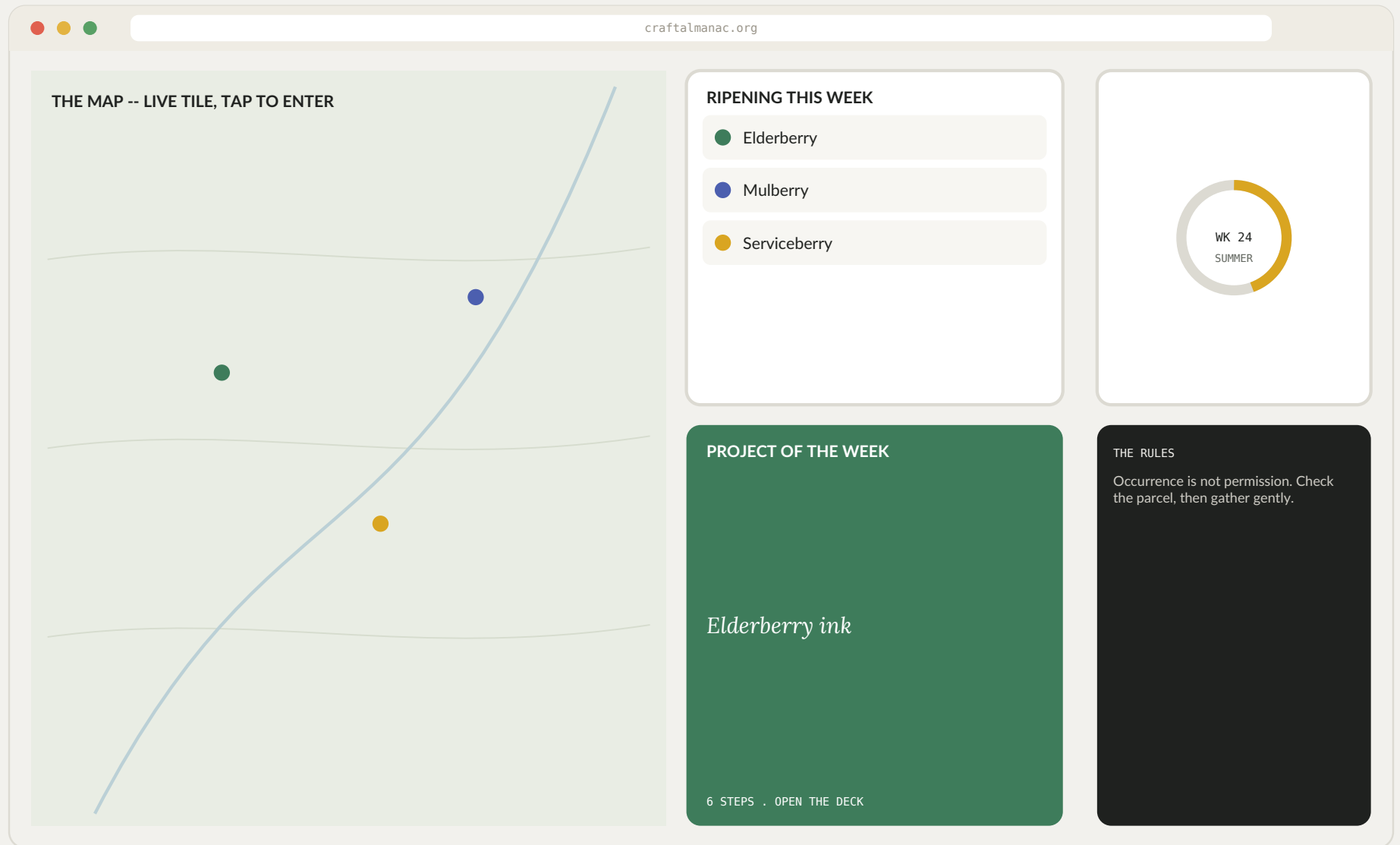
DECLINES

Full-bleed map home; long scrolls. Everything is glanceable.

PRECEDENTS

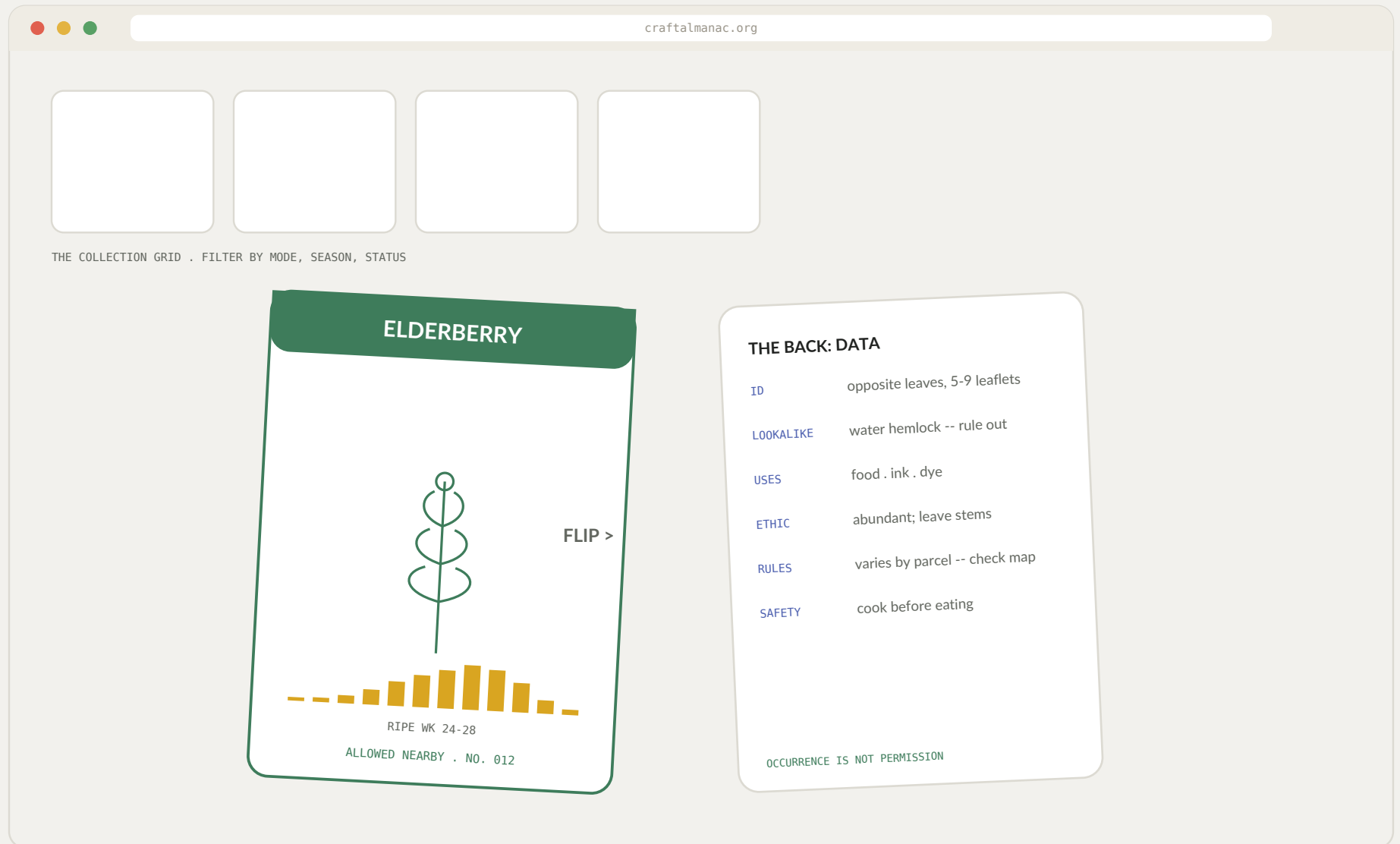
Apple/Vercel bento, Linear grids, Bruno Simon's playability, trading-card UI.

VERSION C / HOME = THE BENTO TABLE



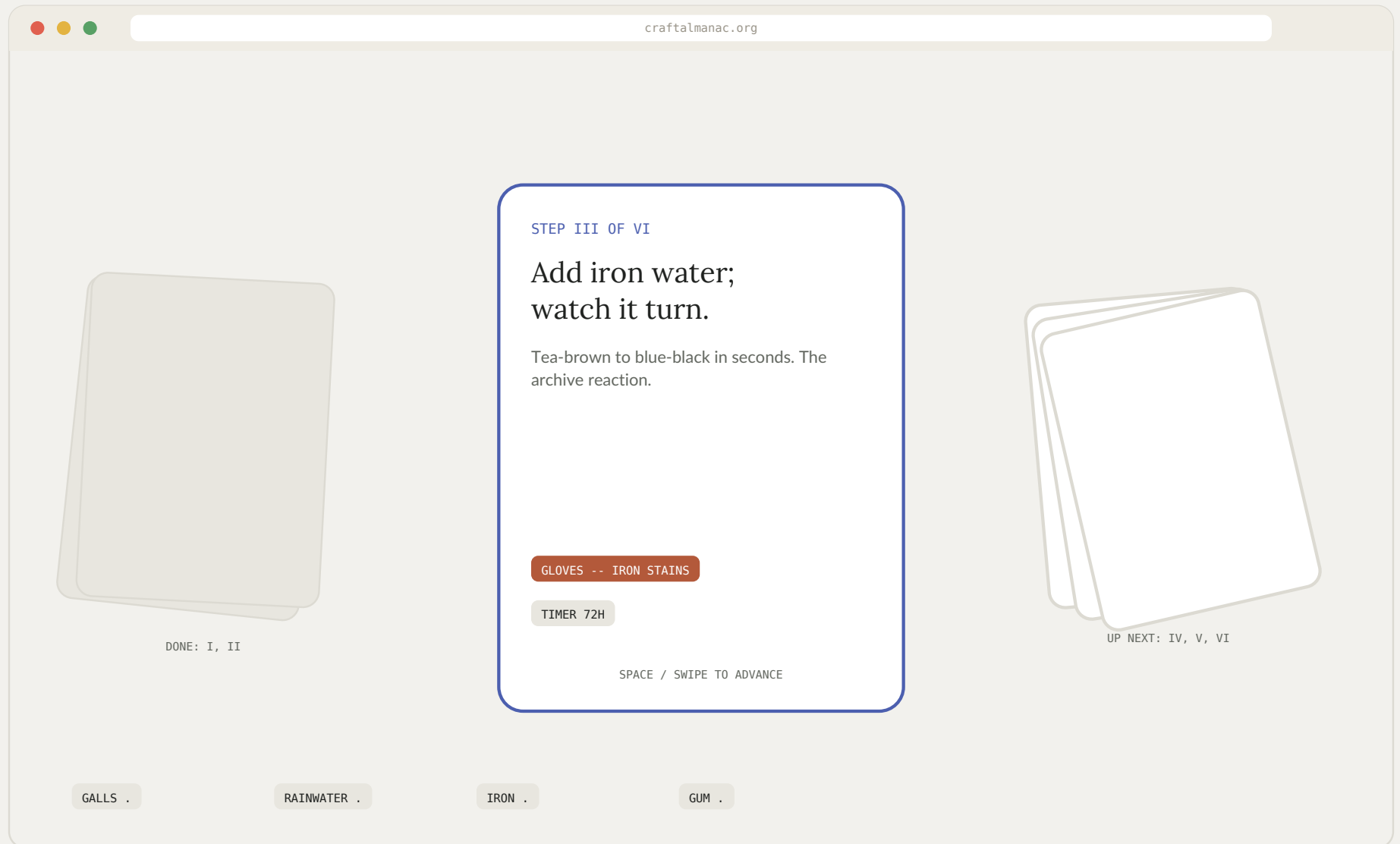
Apple/Vercel bento spent on an almanac: six glanceable surfaces, no scroll, every tile alive (the map pans slowly, the dial turns, the stack reshuffles weekly). Tiles morph into their full pages via View Transitions. The ethics tile is permanent furniture.

VERSION C / PLANT CARD = A CARD, LITERALLY



Cards tilt to the cursor and flip for data -- the one playable element, per Bruno Simon's lesson. Front teaches recognition; back is the citation layer. A card expands to the full page (View Transition) for print. Field cards, not collectibles: you log 'observed', never 'harvested' -- play must not gamify extraction.

VERSION C / RECIPE = A DECK OF STEPS



The recipe is a deck you work through; finished cards stack with a flick. One card, one action -- the strongest hands-busy format on a phone propped by the sink. Materials are cards too, linking to their plants and map spots. The whole deck prints as a sheet of actual cards to cut out for the classroom.

VERSION C / MOTION, TECH + RISK

INTERACTION	BEHAVIOR	COST
Tile hover	lifts 4px, shadow deepens; map tile pans slowly always	CSS transform/transition
Card tilt	3D tilt toward cursor, max 6 degrees	CSS perspective + pointermove
Card flip	front/back rotate on tap	CSS 3D rotate, backface-visibility
Tile to page	bento tile morphs to full page	View Transitions API
Deck advance	card slides off, next springs in; swipe on touch	~80 lines vanilla
Layout	tiles reflow by container size, not viewport	container queries

RISKS

Two real ones. Playfulness vs. safety: status banners and the ethics tile never play -- fixed styles, no tilt, no flip. Gamified collecting could imply harvest bingo: the language is 'observed' and 'made', never completion percentages over living things. And bento homes can fragment focus -- the map tile must clearly dominate the hierarchy.

SIDE BY SIDE

Three versions against the needs

	A . FIELD DESK	B . LONG SEASON	C . CARD TABLE
First minute	drops you into the instrument	tells you the week's story	lays the table, you choose
Map's role	is the site	a recurring character	the biggest card
Plant card	side sheet over the map	sticky editorial spread	a literal card, front/back
Recipe	cook mode with rail + timers	stepped story with thread	deck of step cards
Returning user	fastest: URL + palette	pill skips to map	table is the dashboard
Teaching	daybreak theme, mono rigor	prints one-pagers; reads aloud	cut-out card sheets
Mobile	bottom drawers, app-native	simple stack, scroll-native	swipe decks, touch-native
Signature tech	cmd-K, View Transitions	CSS scroll scenes, sticky	tilt/flip, container queries
Biggest risk	cold power-tool feel	story slows tasks; needs auto-text	play vs. safety tone

All three keep: safety semantics, the ethics line in every popup and card, printability, reduced-motion fallbacks, and the no-build constraint. Any Round 2 world can skin any of these skeletons -- identity and UX are now separate decisions.

Four asks

01 Which skeleton?

Pick a lead UX version (or a hybrid: e.g., B's story home opening into A's instrument). This is separable from the Round 2 identity pick.

02 Pair it with a world.

Any Round 2 world fits any skeleton -- Night Survey on Field Desk is the natural pair; Overprint on Card Table is the boldest; Pigment Index on Long Season the most literary. Name a pairing to prototype.

03 The first playable.

Each version has one signature interactive (season scrubber / pinned map scenes / tilt-flip cards). Which earns a build-first prototype on design/relaunch?

04 Recipe priority.

Recipes are new surface area. Confirm the first three projects (oak-gall ink? elderberry ink? a dye?) so card and recipe templates are designed against real content.

Suggested next step: a one-page HTML prototype of the chosen skeleton's signature interaction, with real map data, before any visual identity is applied.